

THE IMPROVING EDGE | Sean Antonello, VP, Solution Delivery (SAP Analytics)

INTRO SCRIPT

Welcome to **The Improving Edge**. This is where we talk about how AI and technology actually show up in real organizations; what works, what doesn't, and what we're learning along the way. I'll be sharing conversations with people doing the work, turning innovation into outcomes.

Season 1, Episode 9

AI Analytics for the CFO: Risk, ROI, and What Leaders Miss

Episode Overview

We'll discuss where AI risk actually shows up in organizations, and why it's rarely where leaders expect. Sean Antonello brings a rare dual lens: finance leader and enterprise architect. We'll dig into the gap between AI theater and real ROI, what operational readiness looks like, where SAP is getting AI right, and the mental model shift executives need when evaluating AI in their analytics stack.

Key Discussion Topics

#	TOPIC	FOCUS
1	AI Risk vs. Reality	Where financial bleed and false ROI signals show up first: not security, not privacy.
2	Operational Readiness	What AI exposes about weak processes and what "not ready" actually looks like.
3	Competitive Risk	The recklessness spectrum: moving too fast vs. too slow, and what each costs.
4	Governance Gaps	Shadow AI, common blind spots, and what a healthy AI risk posture looks like.
5	Leadership Blind Spots	Why AI surfaces them fast and what to check if you think "we're probably fine."
6	Where SAP Gets It Right	What SAP is actually doing well in AI/analytics that executives are underrating.
7	Reframing AI Evaluation	The mental model shift executives need when evaluating AI in their analytics stack.

Prompting Questions

1. On Financial Risk

"Everyone talks about AI as a growth driver, but where does risk actually show up first? And how is it different from traditional tech risk?"

2. On Operations

"You've worked on both sides: finance and architecture. When you look at an organization's operations through an AI lens, what does 'not ready' actually look like?"

3. On Governance

"Shadow AI is a real thing right now: employees going around leadership to use AI tools. Is this getting better or worse, and what separates companies that handle it well?"

4. On Competitive Risk

"What does recklessness actually look like with AI adoption, and are companies more at risk of moving too fast or too slow right now?"

5. On Leadership

"AI seems to expose leadership blind spots really quickly. Why is that, and if an executive finds themselves thinking 'we're probably fine,' what should they check first?"

6. On Where SAP Gets It Right

"You live in the SAP analytics world. Setting aside the hype, where is SAP actually getting AI right? What should executives be paying closer attention to that they might be underrating?"

7. On Reframing AI Evaluation

"If you could give executives one mental model shift for how they evaluate AI in their analytics stack, what would it be? What are most of them getting wrong in how they even frame the question?"

8. Wrap-Up

"What are a couple of takeaways you'd like the listeners to walk away with?"

REMEMBER: Keep it conversational (60% guest / 40% host) • Share personal stories • Have fun!

Sportcoat: _____